

ANGEL ACTION · WOUNDS & BLEEDING

Severe External Bleeding

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Immediate action

1. Call **000** for severe bleeding.
2. Follow **DRSABCD**.
3. Lie the person down and expose the wound (cut clothing if needed).
4. Apply **firm, direct, continuous pressure** with your hand, a clean cloth or a pad.
5. Once bleeding is controlled, hold the pressure in place with a firm bandage.
6. Keep pressure on — do **not** lift the dressing to check.
7. Treat for **shock** and keep the person warm.

Embedded objects

Do **not** remove an object stuck in a wound. Apply pressure on either side of the object and build up pads around it to prevent movement before bandaging.

Amputation

- Control bleeding with direct pressure.
- Wrap the amputated part in a clean dry cloth, place it in a plastic bag, then place the bag on ice — **never on ice directly** or in water.
- Send to hospital with the patient.

Tourniquet

A commercial tourniquet should only be used for life-threatening limb bleeding that cannot be controlled with direct pressure. Apply 5–7 cm above the wound (not over a joint), tighten until bleeding stops and note the time.

Adapted from Australian First Aid 5th Edition. Get the full guide and live CPR metronome at firstaidangel.org.